

SNIPPETS

L&T sells a third of Satyam stake

Larsen & Toubro (L&T) has sold 2.32 per cent stake in IT company Mahindra Satyam, which was formerly known as Satyam Computer Services, for Rs 3060 million. L&T, which still holds 4.58 per cent in Mahindra Satyam, has divested over 27.2 million shares. L&T was one of the suitors for the erstwhile Satyam Computer Services but had lost the bid to Tech Mahindra in April this year.

Infosys to double sales staff

Infosys Technologies plans to increase its sales and client services headcount by almost 50 per cent by the end of this financial year, most of which will happen in Europe. It will add another 100 to 200 people worldwide in sales and client services on a base of 500. The headcount increase could happen for sales people in infrastructure and applications services.

HTC to re-enter netbook market

Taiwan-based phone maker HTC is planning to re-enter the netbook market, which is hotter than ever today with every manufacturer seeing huge business opportunity in this sector. Couple of years ago, HTC launched laptops like HTC Advantage and HTC Shift, which failed to woo the customers. But this time, the company says that its offering will be unique in some way, but didn't say which direction they were considering.

No significant hiring this year: Microsoft India

Microsoft India is going easy on hiring this year and will instead focus on consolidation. Ravi Venkatesan, chairman and corporate vice president, Microsoft India said on the sidelines of the India Economic Summit. He shared that Steve Barmer (global CEO) had recently gone on record saying that this is a period of consolidation, rather than adding to the headcount. Microsoft, which has a headcount of 5300 people in the country, had hired a few hundreds last year.

Accenture to hire 8000 by 2010

IT and consultancy firm Accenture will add around 8000 people in India by the end of next year, taking its total employee base in the country to 50,000. Indicating a recovery from the global downturn, the company will continue to focus in India, specially in the areas of analytics.

in the global economy and competitive environment make further cost reductions necessary.

Nokia Siemens is also reorganising the company's business to better align with customer needs. The company's five business units are planned to be realigned into three, each targeting a specific customer base. The new business units, which are expected to come into being on January 1, 2010, are for business solutions, network systems and global services.

The revamping and cost cutting came after the company reported a loss of \$836 million in its third quarter.

Cisco to buy set-top box business of China's DVN

Cisco has agreed to buy the set-top box business of DVN (Holdings) for

\$44.5 million. Under the terms of the agreement, the two companies expect to work together with the aim of providing uninterrupted service to set-top box customers and to prepare for an orderly transfer of the business.

As part of the agreement, Cisco will make an up-front payment of approximately \$17.5 million, with an additional maximum amount of \$27 million to be paid over four years, based on the achievement of specific sales milestones.

Cisco has also entered into a go-to-market alliance with the remainder of the DVN organisation, which will continue to be led by current DVN CEO Terry Lui. The alliance will provide joint customers with end-to-end capabilities through the evolution from

basic digital broadcast to advanced interactive services.

STMicro to integrate NXP's MIFARE into security solutions

NXP, the independent semiconductor company founded by Philips and STMicroelectronics, has entered into a global strategic licencing agreement for NXP's MIFARE technology. The agreement enables STMicroelectronics to integrate the entire MIFARE family into its security solutions for mobile phone and banking applications. It will facilitate the convergence of the MIFARE infrastructure and near field communication (NFC)-enabled mobile devices, accelerating worldwide contactless application deployments.

The licencing agreement provides operators and device vendors with widened availability of contactless smart card ICs incorporating the MIFARE technology used in public transport networks, ticketing systems and access management worldwide.

AMD lays out 2010-11 PC roadmap

AMD has unveiled new details on its platform roadmap for 2010 and 2011 on the occasion of its Financial Analyst Day. In 2009, the company plans to launch new server and client platforms designed to deliver superior performance against key end-user workloads. In 2011, it plans to introduce its AMD fusion products. The company's 2010 roadmap is based on code names rather than products.

According to the company, it is all set to launch 'Danube' – the next AMD mainstream notebook platform featuring the first AMD mobile quad-core processors. Danube is expected to offer seven or more hours of battery life.

The other products by AMD include 'Nile,' the third-generation AMD ultrathin notebook platform and two new DDR3-based server platforms – 'San Marino' and 'Maranello.' In 2011, AMD plans new x86 cores 'Bulldozer' and 'Bobcat.'